INCH-POUND

A-A-20274
September 24, 1997

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BEANS, WESTERN STYLE, CANNED

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers western style beans, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by Federal, State, and local governments and other interested parties.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

2.1 The western style beans shall conform to the types of beans in the following list which shall be specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Types of beans.

Type of bean I - Pinto
Type of bean II - Pink
Type of bean III - Red
Type of bean IV - Black

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Finished product:

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Programs, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243 or telephone (202) 720-9939 or FAX (202) 690-0102.

FSC 8915

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3.1.1 **Ingredients:** The finished product shall contain beans, water, tomato paste, chili peppers, spices, and other suitable seasonings and flavorings and may contain a blend of vegetable oils and animal fat, and vegetables such as peppers, tomatoes, onions, corn, etc.

3.1.2 **Flavor and odor:** The canned western style beans shall possess characteristic flavor and odor. The canned western style beans shall be free from objectionable or foreign flavors or odors; e.g., scorched, sour, bitter, etc.

3.1.3 **Color:** The canned western style beans shall possess a characteristic color.

3.1.4 **Texture:** The canned western style beans shall not be hard or mushy.

3.1.5 **Age requirement:** Unless otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the canned western style beans shall be prepared and processed from the current year's crop.

3.1.6 **Foreign material:** All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from evidence of rodent or insect infestation.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

4.1 The delivered canned western style beans shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of the canned western style beans in the commercial marketplace. Delivered canned western style beans shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 **Product conformance.** The canned western style beans provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer's own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same canned western style beans offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 **Quality assurance.** When the solicitation, contract, or purchase order requires that the canned western style beans quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Programs, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable PPB procedures. The canned western style beans shall be examined or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in this CID,

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solicitation, contract, or purchase order, and, when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers in effect on the date of the solicitation.

6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 Purchasers shall specify:

- Type of bean(s) desired.

7.2 Sources of documents.

7.2.1 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This document may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1800.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from: **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243.**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 East L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**

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CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

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